Essential English Grammar Guide

A complete reference for grammar, vocabulary and everyday communication

Tenses · Modal Verbs · Conditionals · Vocabulary · Exercises

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1 Present Simple

Habits, routines and permanent truths

The present simple is the most fundamental tense in English. We use it to talk about things that happen regularly, facts that are always true, and permanent situations. It is not used for actions happening right now — that is the job of the present continuous.

When to use it

- Habits and routines: *She drinks coffee every morning.*
- General truths and facts: *Water boils at 100°C.*
- Permanent situations: *He lives in New York.*
- Timetables and schedules: *The train leaves at 8:00.*

> **I / You / We / They + base verb He / She / It + verb + –s / –es / –ies**

Spelling rules for he / she / it

Rule	Example
Most verbs: add –s	**work → works, play → plays**
Verbs ending in –s, –sh, –ch, –x, –o: add –es	**watch → watches, go → goes**
Verbs ending in consonant + y: change –y to –ies	**study → studies, fly → flies**

Examples

I work in a hospital.

Trabajo en un hospital.

She studies English every evening.

Ella estudia inglés todas las tardes.

They play football on Saturdays.

Ellos juegan fútbol los sábados.

He watches the news at night.

Él ve las noticias en la noche.

The train leaves at eight o'clock.

El tren sale a las ocho.

Note: Do not use the present simple for actions happening at this exact moment. Say 'I am reading' not 'I read' when you mean right now.

Exercises

1. I _____ English every day. (study)
2. She _____ in a bank. (work)
3. They _____ football on weekends. (play)
4. He _____ the news in the evening. (watch)
5. The train _____ at eight. (leave)

Answers

1. study · 2. works · 3. play · 4. watches · 5. leaves

2 Present Continuous

Actions happening now or around this time

The present continuous describes actions that are in progress at the moment of speaking, or situations that are temporary and happening around now. It can also be used to talk about fixed plans in the near future.

When to use it

• Actions in progress right now: *She is cooking dinner.*

• Temporary situations: *I am living in Madrid for three months.*

• Changing or developing situations: *Prices are rising.*

• Fixed plans in the near future: *We are meeting tomorrow at noon.*

> **am / is / are + verb + –ing**

Spelling rules for –ing

Rule	Example
Most verbs: add –ing	**work → working, read → reading**
Verbs ending in –e: drop the –e, add –ing	**write → writing, make → making**
Short verbs ending in consonant + vowel + consonant: double the last consonant	**run → running, sit → sitting**

Examples

I am reading a really good book right now.

Estoy leyendo un libro muy bueno ahora mismo.

She is cooking pasta for dinner.

Ella está cocinando pasta para cenar.

They are studying for their exams.

Ellos están estudiando para sus exámenes.

I am living in Mexico for two months.

Estoy viviendo en México por dos meses.

We are meeting the client tomorrow morning.

Nos reunimos con el cliente mañana por la mañana.

Note: Some verbs are rarely used in the continuous form: know, like, love, hate, want, need, believe, understand. We say 'I know the answer,' not 'I am knowing the answer.'

Exercises

1. She _____ (cook) dinner right now.
2. They _____ (study) for their exams this week.
3. I _____ (live) in this city for a year.
4. He _____ (work) on a new project.
5. We _____ (meet) our manager this afternoon.

Answers

1. is cooking · 2. are studying · 3. am living · 4. is working · 5. are meeting

3 Past Simple

Completed actions at a specific point in the past

The past simple is used for actions that started and finished in the past. Unlike the present perfect, the past simple requires a specific time reference — we know exactly when something happened. English has two types of verbs in the past: regular and irregular.

When to use it

• Completed actions with a specific time: *She called me yesterday.*

• A series of completed events: *He woke up, had breakfast and went to work.*

• Past habits (with 'used to' or frequency words): *We often went to the beach.*

> **Regular verbs: verb + –ed (work → worked, play → played) Irregular verbs: change form entirely (go → went, buy → bought, eat → ate)**

Common irregular verbs

Base form	Past simple	Base form	Past simple
be	**was / were**	go	**went**
have	**had**	see	**saw**
take	**took**	buy	**bought**
eat	**ate**	come	**came**
give	**gave**	say	**said**
get	**got**	make	**made**

Examples

I worked late last night.

Trabajé hasta tarde anoche.

She visited her family last week.

Ella visitó a su familia la semana pasada.

They went to the store two hours ago.

Ellos fueron a la tienda hace dos horas.

He bought a new car.

Él compró un auto nuevo.

We took the early train.

Tomamos el tren temprano.

Note: For negatives and questions in the past simple, use 'did / didn't' + base verb: 'Did you go?' / 'I didn't go.' Never add –ed twice: not 'I didn't worked.'

Exercises

1. I _____ English all weekend. (study)
2. She _____ a great film on Saturday. (watch)
3. They _____ to the park after lunch. (go)
4. He _____ a new laptop. (buy)
5. We _____ the last train home. (take)

Answers

1. studied · 2. watched · 3. went · 4. bought · 5. took

4 Past Continuous

Actions in progress at a specific moment in the past

The past continuous describes an action that was already in progress when something else happened. It paints the background of a story. It is often used with the past simple: the past continuous gives the context, the past simple gives the event.

When to use it

• An action in progress at a past moment: *At 9 p.m. I was reading.*

• Background for another event: *I was cooking when she arrived.*

• Two parallel actions in the past: *While he was driving, she was sleeping.*

> **was / were + verb + –ing**

Examples

I was reading when the phone rang.

Estaba leyendo cuando sonó el teléfono.

She was cooking dinner at seven o'clock.

Ella estaba cocinando la cena a las siete.

While I was studying, he was listening to music.

Mientras yo estudiaba, él veía la tele.

They were playing outside when it started to rain.

Ellos estaban jugando afuera cuando empezó a llover.

We were talking about you when you walked in.

Estábamos hablando de ti cuando entraste.

Note: Use 'when' before a past simple verb (the event) and 'while' before a past continuous verb (the background action). 'While I was sleeping, the alarm went off.'

Exercises

1. I _____ (study) when she called me.
2. She _____ (cook) dinner at eight last night.
3. While I _____ (read), he _____ (work).
4. They _____ (play) cards when the lights went out.
5. What _____ you _____ (do) at midnight?

Answers

1. was studying · 2. was cooking · 3. was reading / was working · 4. were playing · 5. were / doing

5

Future with Will

Spontaneous decisions, promises and predictions

We use 'will' for three main purposes: decisions made at the moment of speaking, promises and offers, and predictions based on what we believe or expect. It is not used for plans made in advance — for that, we use 'going to'.

When to use it

• Spontaneous decisions: *The phone is ringing. I'll get it.*

• Promises and offers: *I'll help you with that. I won't tell anyone.*

• Predictions with no evidence: *I think it will be cold tomorrow.*

• Facts about the future: *She'll be thirty next year.*

> **Positive: will + base verb (I will call you.) Negative: won't + base verb (She won't be late.) Question: Will + subject + verb? (Will they come?)**

Examples

I'll call you tonight, I promise.

Te llamaré esta noche, lo prometo.

Don't worry — everything will be fine.

No te preocupes — todo saldrá bien.

She won't be late. She is always on time.

Ella no llegará tarde. Siempre es puntual.

Will you help me with this report?

¿Me ayudarás con este informe?

I think it will rain this afternoon.

Creo que lloverá esta tarde.

Note: Never use 'will' after 'if' in a conditional sentence. Say 'If it rains, I will stay home' — not 'If it will rain...'

Exercises

1. I _____ travel to Japan next year. (will)
2. She _____ call you as soon as she arrives. (will)
3. They _____ be late. They left an hour ago. (won't)
4. _____ you help me move this table? (Will)
5. I think it _____ snow tomorrow. (will)

Answers

1. will · 2. will · 3. won't · 4. Will · 5. will

6 Future: Going To

Plans, intentions and predictions with evidence

We use 'going to' when we have already decided to do something before the moment of speaking, or when there is visible evidence that something is about to happen. This is the key difference from 'will': 'going to' is for pre-made plans, not spontaneous ones.

When to use it

• Pre-planned decisions: *We are going to move to a new house next month.*

• Intentions: *I am going to learn how to cook.*

• Predictions with present evidence: *Look at those clouds — it's going to rain.*

> **am / is / are + going to + base verb**

Examples

I am going to study French starting next month.

Voy a estudiar francés a partir del mes que viene.

She is going to visit her parents this weekend.

Ella va a visitar a sus padres este fin de semana.

They are going to buy a house in the spring.

Ellos van a comprar una casa en la primavera.

Look at those clouds — it's going to storm.

Mira esas nubes — va a haber tormenta.

We are going to be late if we don't leave now.

Vamos a llegar tarde si no salimos ahora.

Note: Quick comparison: 'I'll have the salad' (you just decided at the table) vs. 'I'm going to have the salad' (you already decided before the waiter came).

Exercises

1. I _____ (go) to the gym three times a week from now on.
2. She _____ (visit) her grandmother this weekend.
3. Look out — he _____ (fall)!
4. We _____ (not / be) late. We planned carefully.
5. _____ they _____ (move) to a new apartment?

Answers

1. am going to go · 2. is going to visit · 3. is going to fall · 4. are not going to be · 5. Are / going to move

7

Present Perfect

Past actions with a connection to the present

The present perfect connects the past with the present. We use it when we are interested in the result or relevance of a past action, not the specific time it happened. If you mention a specific time (yesterday, last year), use the past simple instead.

When to use it

• Experiences in your life (unspecified time): *I have been to Japan.*

• Recent events with present relevance: *She has just arrived.*

• Actions completed with result: *I have finished the report — here it is.*

• With yet, already, just, ever, never: *Have you ever tried sushi?*

> **have / has + past participle Common past participles: finished, visited, studied, been, gone, seen, eaten, made**

Examples

I have finished the project.

He terminado el proyecto.

She has visited Paris three times.

Ella ha visitado París tres veces.

They have never traveled by plane.

Ellos nunca han viajado en avión.

Have you ever eaten Thai food?

¿Alguna vez has comido comida tailandesa?

He has just left the office.

Él acaba de salir de la oficina.

Note: Key time words: already (before now), yet (up to now, used in negatives/questions), just (a moment ago), ever (at any time in your life), never (at no time).

Exercises

1. I _____ just _____ the report. (finish)
2. She _____ never _____ to Asia. (be)
3. Have you ever _____ sushi? (try)
4. They _____ already _____ the film. (see)
5. He _____ just _____ home. (arrive)

Answers

1. have / finished · 2. has / been · 3. tried · 4. have / seen · 5. has / arrived

8 Past Perfect

Actions completed before another past event

The past perfect is the 'past of the past.' We use it to show that one action was completed before another action in the past. It is often used in stories and narratives to show the order of events clearly.

had + past participle (for all persons: I / you / he / she / we / they)

Examples

By the time I arrived, the meeting had already started.

Cuando llegué, la reunión ya había comenzado.

She had studied all night before the exam.

Ella había estudiado toda la noche antes del examen.

They had never met before that evening.

Ellos nunca se habían conocido antes de esa noche.

After he had eaten, he went for a walk.

Después de que había comido, fue a caminar.

I realised I had left my keys at home.

Me di cuenta de que había dejado mis llaves en casa.

Note: The past perfect is especially common with 'before,' 'after,' 'by the time,' 'already' and 'never.' It helps the reader understand which event happened first.

Exercises

1. By the time she arrived, we _____ (finish) dinner.
2. He _____ (study) all night before the test.
3. I realised I _____ (forget) my passport.
4. They _____ (already / eat) when we got there.
5. After she _____ (leave), we found her phone.

Answers

1. had finished · 2. had studied · 3. had forgotten · 4. had already eaten · 5. had left

9 Modal Verbs

Expressing ability, possibility, obligation and advice

Modal verbs are special auxiliary verbs that add meaning to the main verb. They never change form (no –s, no –ing, no –ed) and are always followed by the base form of the verb. The most common modals are: can, could, may, might, must, should, ought to, will, would.

Key modals and their uses

Modal	Use	Example
can	Ability (present)	**She can speak three languages.**
could	Ability (past) / polite request	**Could you help me, please?**
must	Strong obligation / deduction	**You must wear a seatbelt.**
have to	External obligation	**I have to submit this today.**
should	Advice / recommendation	**You should see a doctor.**
may / might	Possibility	**It might rain later.**
would	Conditional / polite request	**Would you like some coffee?**

Note: Never add 'to' after a modal verb (except 'have to' and 'ought to'). Say 'I can swim' — not 'I can to swim.' Modals do not have an infinitive, a past participle or a gerund form.

Exercises

1. She _____ speak Japanese. (ability)
2. You _____ study harder. (advice)
3. He _____ be at least 40. (deduction)
4. _____ you open the window, please? (polite request)
5. It _____ snow tonight. (possibility)

Answers

1. can · 2. should · 3. must · 4. Could · 5. might

10

Comparatives & Superlatives

Comparing people, things and places

Comparatives are used to compare two things. Superlatives are used to show the highest or lowest degree within a group. The form changes depending on the number of syllables in the adjective.

Adjective type	Comparative	Superlative
One syllable	**+ –er (taller)**	**the + –est (the tallest)**
One syllable ending CVC	**double + –er (bigger)**	**the + double + –est (the biggest)**
Two syllables ending –y	**change –y to –ier (happier)**	**the + –iest (the happiest)**
Two or more syllables	**more + adjective (more interesting)**	**the most + adjective (the most beautiful)**
Irregular	**good → better, bad → worse, far → further**	**the best, the worst, the furthest**

Examples

This book is more interesting than that one.

Este libro es más interesante que aquel.

She is taller than her sister.

Ella es más alta que su hermana.

This is the most expensive restaurant in the city.

Este es el restaurante más caro de la ciudad.

He is the best student in the class.

Él es el mejor estudiante de la clase.

Today is worse than yesterday.

Hoy es peor que ayer.

Exercises

1. Write the comparative of: tall.
2. Write the superlative of: small.
3. This film is _____ (interesting) than the last one.
4. She is _____ (good) student in the school.
5. Today is _____ (bad) than yesterday.

Answers

1. taller · 2. the smallest · 3. more interesting · 4. the best · 5. worse

11

Adverbs of Frequency

Saying how often something happens

Adverbs of frequency tell us how often an action occurs. In English, their position in the sentence is fixed: they go before the main verb, but after the verb 'to be.'

Adverb	Approximate frequency	Example
always	100%	**She always arrives on time.**
usually / normally	80–90%	**I usually have coffee in the morning.**
often / frequently	60–70%	**They often go to the cinema.**
sometimes	30–50%	**He sometimes works from home.**
rarely / seldom	10–20%	**We rarely eat fast food.**
never	0%	**I never drink alcohol.**

Note: Position rule: BEFORE the main verb ('I always eat breakfast') but AFTER the verb 'to be' ('She is never late').

Exercises

1. I _____ go to the gym on Mondays. (sometimes)
2. She _____ arrives late. (never)
3. We _____ watch a film on Fridays. (usually)
4. He is _____ ready on time. (always)
5. They are _____ here at this hour. (rarely)

Answers

1. sometimes go · 2. never arrives · 3. usually watch · 4. always ready · 5. rarely here

12

Prepositions

Expressing time, place and direction

Prepositions are short words that link nouns, pronouns and phrases to the rest of the sentence. They show relationships of time, place, direction and manner. The three most common — in, on, at — follow clear patterns.

Preposition	Time	Place
in	**in the morning, in July, in 2024, in winter**	**in Mexico, in a room, in the car**
on	**on Monday, on 5 October, on my birthday**	**on the table, on the wall, on the bus**
at	**at 8 o'clock, at noon, at night, at the weekend**	**at home, at school, at the station**

Other common prepositions

The cat is under the table.

El gato está debajo de la mesa.

The bank is next to the pharmacy.

El banco está al lado de la farmacia.

She walked across the bridge.

Ella cruzó el puente.

The keys are between the books.

Las llaves están entre los libros.

We drove through the tunnel.

Manejamos por el túnel.

Exercises

1. I was born _____ July. (in / on / at)
2. The meeting is _____ Monday. (in / on / at)
3. She arrived _____ 9 o'clock. (in / on / at)
4. The dog is _____ the sofa. (on / under / next to)
5. I live _____ a small apartment _____ the city centre. (in / in)

Answers

1. in · 2. on · 3. at · 4. on / under (both possible) · 5. in / in

13

Articles

A, An and The — introducing nouns correctly

English has two types of article: the indefinite article (a / an) and the definite article (the). Using the wrong article — or omitting it — is one of the most common mistakes in English.

Article	Use	Example
a	Before consonant sounds, first mention, one of many	**a book, a car, a university**
an	Before vowel sounds (a, e, i, o, u)	**an apple, an hour, an honest man**
the	Specific noun, already mentioned, unique things	**the sun, the book I bought, the president**
no article	Uncountable nouns in general, plural in general	**Water is important. Dogs are friendly.**

Note: The choice between 'a' and 'an' depends on the SOUND, not the letter. 'A university' (sounds like 'you') but 'an umbrella.' 'A hour' is wrong — say 'an hour' because 'h' is silent.

Exercises

1. She is eating _____ apple.
2. He has _____ dog and _____ cat.
3. _____ sun is very bright today.
4. I want to be _____ engineer.
5. It takes _____ hour to get there.

Answers

1. an · 2. a / a · 3. The · 4. an · 5. an

14

Pronouns

Replacing nouns to avoid repetition

Pronouns stand in for nouns and noun phrases. English pronouns change form depending on their role in the sentence: subject, object or possessive.

Subject	Object	Poss. adj.	Poss. pron.	Reflexive
I	me	my	mine	myself
you	you	your	yours	yourself
he	him	his	his	himself
she	her	her	hers	herself
it	it	its	—	itself
we	us	our	ours	ourselves
they	them	their	theirs	themselves

Examples

She called me yesterday.

Ella me llamó ayer.

This is my book. Is that yours?

Este es mi libro. ¿Es ese el tuyo?

He fixed it himself.

Él lo arregló él mismo.

They told us about their trip.

Ellos nos contaron sobre su viaje.

Exercises

1. _____ is my sister. (She)
2. Can you help _____? (me)
3. Is this bag _____? (yours)
4. They did it _____. (themselves)
5. We told _____ about the party. (them)

Answers

1. She · 2. me · 3. yours · 4. themselves · 5. them

15 Questions & Negatives

Asking and making negative statements

In English, forming questions and negatives requires an auxiliary verb. The auxiliary verb changes depending on the tense. This is different from many other languages where the main verb changes position.

Questions: Auxiliary + subject + main verb? Do you live here? / Did she call? Negatives: Subject + auxiliary + not + verb I don't know. / She didn't come.

Tense	Auxiliary	Question	Negative
Present simple	do / does	Do you like it? / Does she work?	I don't know. / She doesn't work.
Past simple	did	Did they arrive?	He didn't come.
Present continuous	am / is / are	Are you coming?	I'm not coming.
Present perfect	have / has	Have you eaten?	I haven't eaten.
Future will	will	Will she call?	I won't go.

Note: When using 'does' or 'did,' the main verb goes back to its base form. Say 'Does she work?' not 'Does she works?' and 'Did you go?' not 'Did you went?'

Exercises

1. _____ you like coffee? (present simple question)
2. She _____ speak German. (present simple negative)
3. _____ he play the piano? (present simple question)
4. I _____ understand the question. (negative)
5. _____ they finish on time? (past simple question)

Answers

1. Do · 2. doesn't · 3. Does · 4. don't · 5. Did

16

Phrasal Verbs

Verbs + particles that create new meanings

Phrasal verbs are combinations of a verb and one or more particles (prepositions or adverbs). The resulting meaning is often very different from the individual words. They are extremely common in everyday spoken English.

Phrasal verb	Meaning	Example
get up	rise from bed	I get up at seven every morning.
give up	stop trying / quit	Don't give up — you're almost there.
look for	search for	I'm looking for my glasses.
look after	take care of	Can you look after my dog this weekend?
turn on / off	activate / deactivate	Turn on the lights. Turn off the radio.
find out	discover information	I found out she was leaving.
put off	postpone	We put off the meeting until next week.
carry on	continue	Carry on with your work.
run out of	have no more of	We've run out of coffee.
go on	continue / happen	What's going on?

Note: Some phrasal verbs are separable: 'Turn off the radio' = 'Turn the radio off.' Others are inseparable: 'Look after the baby' — NOT 'Look the baby after.' Always check when you learn a new one.

Exercises

1. What time do you _____ in the morning? (get up)
2. Don't _____! You are almost finished. (give up)
3. I am _____ my phone. Have you seen it? (look for)
4. We have _____ milk. Can you buy some? (run out of)
5. She _____ the meeting until Friday. (put off)

Answers

1. get up · 2. give up · 3. looking for · 4. run out of · 5. put off

17

Conditionals

Expressing real, hypothetical and impossible situations

Conditionals describe the result of a condition. English has four main conditional forms, each expressing a different degree of reality or possibility.

Type	Use	Structure	Example
Zero	General truths	If + present / present	If you heat water to 100°C, it boils.
First	Real / likely future	If + present / will	If it rains, I will take an umbrella.
Second	Unreal / hypothetical	If + past / would	If I had more time, I would travel.
Third	Unreal past	If + past perfect / would have	If she had studied, she would have passed.

Examples

If it rains tomorrow, I will stay at home.

Si llueve mañana, me quedaré en casa.

If I had more money, I would buy a bigger house.

Si tuviera más dinero, compraría una casa más grande.

If she had arrived earlier, she would have met him.

Si hubiera llegado antes, lo habría conocido.

If you mix red and blue, you get purple.

Si mezclas rojo y azul, obtienes morado.

Note: Never use 'will' in the 'if' clause of a first conditional. Correct: 'If it rains, I will stay.' Wrong: 'If it will rain, I will stay.'

Exercises

1. If it _____ (rain), I _____ (stay) home. (1st conditional)
2. If I _____ (be) rich, I _____ (travel) the world. (2nd)
3. If she _____ (study), she _____ (pass) the exam. (1st)
4. If they _____ (leave) earlier, they _____ (catch) the train. (3rd)
5. If you _____ (heat) ice, it _____ (melt). (zero)

Answers

1. rains / will stay · 2. were / would travel · 3. studies / will pass · 4. had left / would have caught · 5. heat / melts

18 Work Vocabulary

The language of the professional world

Here is essential vocabulary for talking about work, the office and professional life.

English	Español	English	Español
meeting	*reunión*	**deadline**	*fecha límite*
salary	*salario*	**colleague**	*colega*
manager	*jefe / gerente*	**employee**	*empleado*
to hire	*contratar*	**to resign**	*renunciar*
promotion	*ascenso*	**shift**	*turno de trabajo*
remote work	*trabajo remoto*	**invoice**	*factura*
spreadsheet	*hoja de cálculo*	**budget**	*presupuesto*
report	*informe*	**to delegate**	*delegar*
performance	*desempeño*	**feedback**	*retroalimentación*

Useful phrases at work

I have a tight deadline.

Tengo una fecha límite muy próxima.

Could we schedule a meeting for Thursday?

¿Podríamos agendar una reunión para el jueves?

I'd like to give you some feedback.

Me gustaría darte retroalimentación.

She was promoted to senior manager.

Ella fue ascendida a gerente senior.

19

Travel Vocabulary

Getting around the world in English

Whether you are at the airport, hotel or asking for directions, these words and phrases will help you travel with confidence.

English	Español	English	Español
passport	*pasaporte*	**boarding pass**	*tarjeta de embarque*
departure	*salida*	**arrival**	*llegada*
gate	*puerta de embarque*	**customs**	*aduana*
check in	*registrarse*	**check out**	*hacer el check-out*
luggage	*equipaje*	**carry-on**	*equipaje de mano*
delay	*retraso*	**connection**	*conexión*
return ticket	*boleto de ida y vuelta*	**one-way**	*solo ida*
platform	*andén*	**fare**	*tarifa*

Useful phrases when travelling

My flight has been delayed by two hours.

Mi vuelo se retrasó dos horas.

Could you tell me where the nearest metro station is?

¿Me podría decir dónde está la estación de metro más cercana?

I'd like a single room with a sea view.

Quisiera una habitación individual con vista al mar.

What time does the last train leave?

¿A qué hora sale el último tren?

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Food Vocabulary

Talking about food, meals and restaurants

Food is one of the most common topics in conversation. Learn these words to order confidently, describe what you eat and talk about restaurants.

English	Español	English	Español
starter / appetiser	*entrada*	**main course**	*plato principal*
dessert	*postre*	**side dish**	*guarnición*
to order	*ordenar / pedir*	**bill / check**	*cuenta*
tip	*propina*	**waiter / waitress**	*mesero / mesera*
vegetarian	*vegetariano*	**vegan**	*vegano*
gluten-free	*sin gluten*	**well-done**	*bien cocido*
medium	*término medio*	**rare**	*poco hecho*
to be allergic to	*ser alérgico a*	**recipe**	*receta*

Useful phrases at a restaurant

Could I see the menu, please?
¿Me podría traer el menú, por favor?

I'd like the grilled salmon as my main course.
Quisiera el salmón a la plancha como plato principal.

I'm allergic to nuts. Does this dish contain any?
Soy alérgico a las nueces. ¿Este platillo contiene?

Could we have the bill, please?
¿Nos podría traer la cuenta, por favor?